

Insight 1 — Depression is rare but severe when present Only 2.6% of teens (31 out of 1,200) show signs of depression. But when depression is present, the difference is dramatic — depressed teens average 4.8 hours of sleep vs 6.5 hours for healthy teens, and 8.5 stress level vs 5.4. That's a 57% higher stress level and 35% less sleep.

So *what*? Depression in teenagers is not just "feeling sad" — it shows up physically in sleep deprivation and chronic stress. Early screening should focus on these two indicators.

Insight 2 — Stress is the strongest signal, not screen time The scatter plot shows depressed teens clustering at stress levels 7–10 regardless of how many hours they spend on social media. Teens with 1 hour of daily social media can be depressed, and teens with 8 hours can be perfectly fine.

So *what*? Parents and schools focusing only on screen time limits may be addressing the wrong problem. Stress management is more critical.

Insight 3 — No platform is significantly worse than another TikTok, Instagram, and mixed users all show anxiety around 5.4, stress around 5.4, and addiction around 5.3. The differences are less than 0.2 points across all three groups.

So *what*? The narrative that "TikTok is more dangerous than Instagram" is not supported by this data. The platform matters far less than the individual's mental state.

Insight 4 — Social media doesn't explain academic performance The scatter plot of daily social media hours vs academic performance (GPA 2.0–4.0) shows no clear pattern. Red and blue dots are evenly distributed across all usage levels and GPA ranges.

So *what*? A teen spending 8 hours on social media can still achieve a 4.0 GPA. Academic performance is driven by other factors not captured here — motivation, study habits, family support.

Insight 5 — Physical activity has surprisingly little impact on stress Teens with no activity average stress of 5.3, low activity 5.4, and medium activity 5.4. A difference of just 0.1 points across groups.

So *what*? Within this dataset, exercise alone is not a meaningful stress reducer for teenagers. This challenges common health messaging and suggests stress in teens comes from sources that physical activity cannot address — academic pressure, social dynamics, family environment.

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